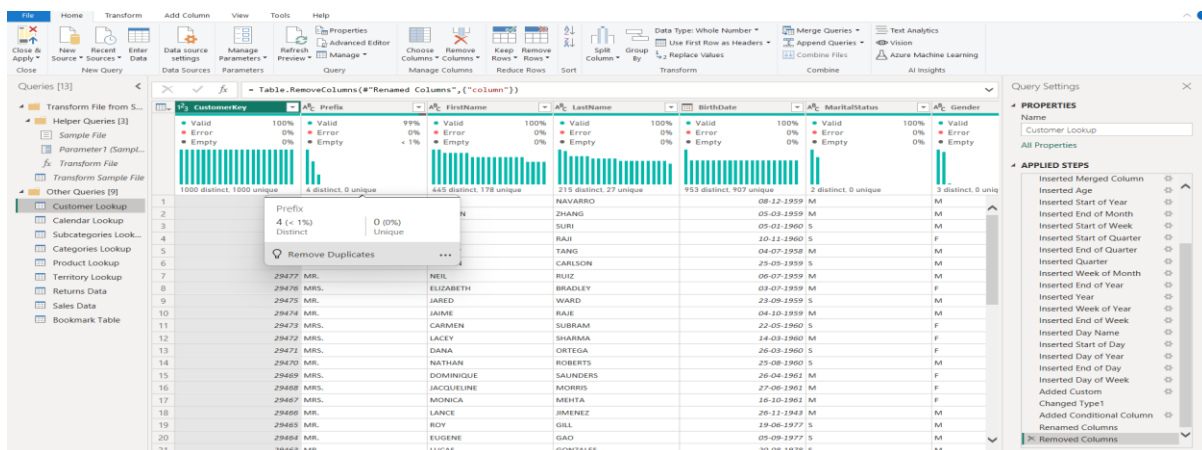


TRANSFORM DATA IN POWER BI

Transform Data refers to the process of **cleaning**, **shaping**, and **preparing** data before using it in your visualizations.

This is done in the **Power Query Editor**, which opens when you click on **Home > Transform Data** in Power BI Desktop.

Think of it like preparing ingredients before cooking — if your data is clean and organized, your reports will be faster, more accurate, and easier to build.



What Can You Do with Transform Data (Power Query)?

Here are some **common data transformation tasks**:

1. Remove Unnecessary Columns/Rows

- Delete columns you don't need to make the model lighter and easier to use.

2. Filter Rows

- Keep only the rows you want — for example, filter out blank values or specific categories.

3. Change Data Types

- Set correct data types (text, number, date, etc.) so Power BI treats your data correctly.

4. Rename Columns

- Give columns meaningful names to make your model more readable.

5. Split Columns

- Break a single column into multiple ones (e.g., split "Full Name" into "First Name" and "Last Name").

6. Merge Columns

- Combine multiple columns into one (e.g., combine "City" and "State").

7. Group By

- Aggregate data by grouping — for example, group sales by region and calculate the total.

8. Replace Values

- Replace wrong or missing values (e.g., change "N/A" to "0").

9. Pivot and Unpivot

- Change the layout of data:
 - Pivot:** Turn rows into columns.
 - Unpivot:** Turn columns into rows (often used to normalize data).

10. Remove Duplicates

- Keep only unique values from a column or table.

11. Add Custom Columns

- Use formulas to create new columns (Power Query uses **M language** for this, different from DAX).

12. Append Queries

- Combine two or more tables with the **same columns** (e.g., monthly sales files).

13. Merge Queries

- Join two tables (like a VLOOKUP) to bring in columns from another table.

